

Chapter 59

Conforming AAF Files

AAF (Advanced Authoring Format) is a project exchange format, originally developed by the Advanced Media Workflow Association (AMWA). Commonly used video applications that export project data in the AAF format include Avid Media Composer, Avid Symphony, Autodesk Smoke and Flame Premium, and Adobe Premiere Pro.

This chapter includes detailed information about recommended workflows for moving projects from Media Composer (or Symphony) to DaVinci Resolve for grading, either as a one-way trip, or as a round-trip workflow in which you return to Avid Media Composer for finishing. Since Media Composer round-trip workflows have many variables, this is covered in depth within this chapter.

The end of this chapter also describes how to import audio projects from Pro Tools that have been exported to AAF.

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Supported Media Types in AAF Workflows

Media Composer provides several methods of ingesting and managing compatible media formats. Ultimately, which formats are suitable for a Media Composer to DaVinci Resolve one-way or round trip depends on whether they're compatible with DaVinci Resolve.

There's one other thing to keep in mind as you're managing media in Media Composer; not all formats are compatible with all media management operations. This combination of format compatibility and operational compatibility requires you to carefully tailor your workflow around which media files you'll be using.

Transcoding to DNxHD or DNxHR Always Works

Since DNxHD and DNxHR were developed to be Media Composer's core codecs, workflows where you transcode other media formats to MXF-wrapped DNxHD/DNxHR before editing will always work, and are the simplest when round tripping between Media Composer and DaVinci Resolve. DaVinci Resolve supports both MXF-wrapped and QuickTime-wrapped DNxHD/DNxHR media.

Linking to Media Using AMA and Consolidating

Avid Media Access (AMA) is a means of directly linking clips to media files in Media Composer without needing to either transcode them to DNxHD/DNxHR MXF files, or copy them to an Avid MediaFiles directory. While convenient, workflows involving media that's linked using AMA require a bit more forethought.

Not all AMA-compatible media formats can be consolidated in Media Composer, which limits your ability to create a smaller, more portable collection of media to move into DaVinci Resolve. Whether or not an AMA-linked clip can be consolidated depends on its media format; Media Composer can only consolidate formats that it can write. For example, since Media Composer cannot write R3D media, then R3D media cannot be consolidated.

Furthermore, not all AMA-compatible media formats are compatible with DaVinci Resolve. Simply being able to edit a media format in a Media Composer timeline doesn't guarantee you can use it in DaVinci Resolve. The following table lists which media formats can be AMA-linked in Media Composer, which formats can be consolidated, and which are compatible for use in DaVinci Resolve.

If you're prepping a sequence that uses a mix of media formats, some of which can be consolidated, and some of which can't, you should transcode all clips that aren't compatible with consolidation to an Avid native codec before beginning the process of consolidating media and exporting an AAF to DaVinci Resolve.

Fast Imported Media

Another wrinkle is that Media Composer supports a media ingest method called “Fast Import,” where imported media is quickly copied to the Avid MediaFiles directory by inserting the original image data using the original codec into an MXF wrapper. This is an extremely fast and efficient way to bring media into Media Composer projects, but the resulting files are not typically compatible with DaVinci Resolve.

On the other hand, keep in mind that any media format that can be Fast Imported can also be consolidated. If you’re planning to round trip a sequence that uses Fast Imported media, it’s recommended that you either transcode the Fast Imported clips to DNxHD prior to AAF export, or conform your exported AAF project to the camera original media in DaVinci Resolve instead.

TIP: Whenever you use a combination of media in your project that includes formats that aren’t compatible with DaVinci Resolve, you can use the “Transcode Video To” checkbox in the options of the Export As dialog when exporting an AAF project. This option lets you to transcode all media that isn’t a compatible format into a format that is compatible. Some non-standard frame sizes will not transcode in Avid and will return an unsupported resolution error.

Codec	Can be Natively AMA-Linked	Can be Consolidated	DaVinci Resolve Compatible
ARRI ALEXA Raw	Non-native support	No	Yes
AVCHD	Yes	No	Yes
AVC-Intra and Long GOP	Yes	Yes	Yes
Blackmagic RAW	Non-native support	No	Yes
Canon XF	Yes	Yes	Yes
Cine (Phantom)	Yes	Yes	Yes
CinemaDNG	No	No	Yes
DVC PRO P2	Yes	Yes	No
QuickTime (ProRes)	Yes	Yes	Yes
R3D (RED)	Non-native support	No	Yes
Sony F65 Raw	Yes	No	Yes
Sony HDCAM SR (SStP)	Non-native support	No	Yes
Sony XAVC	Yes	Yes	Yes
Sony XDCAM	Yes	Yes	Yes

Compatible AMA-linked formats

Logged Errors When Importing AAF

If you turn on the “Import log messages as markers” checkbox in the Load AAF dialog, certain error messages that alert you to issues with the AAF import you’re trying to do will be added as markers with notes to the Timeline. You have an option, via a pop-up embedded within the text of this checkbox, of choosing the color of the markers used to store this information.

The following messages will create markers:

- Transition type ‘XXXX’ is not supported in this release. A Cross Dissolve will be inserted.
- Effect type ‘XXXX’ is not supported in this release. Plain clips will be imported.
- SMPTE Wipe Transition type ‘XXXX’ is not supported in this release. A Cross Dissolve will be inserted.
- Interpolation type ‘XXXX’ is not supported in this release. Linear interpolation will be used.
- The clip ‘XXXX’ failed to link because the timecode extents do not match any clip in the Media Pool.
- Mismatch between specified target timecodes ‘XXXX’ and located file timecodes ‘YYYY.’
- No overlap between specified target timecodes ‘XXXX’ and located file timecodes ‘YYYY.’
- Clip ‘XXXX’ in track ‘XXX’ at timecode ‘UNKNOWN’, with reel name ‘XXXX’ and filename ‘XXXX.’
- Clip ‘XXXX’ in track ‘XXX’ at timecode ‘UNKNOWN’, with reel name ‘XXXX’ and filename ‘XXXX.’
- File not found in search directories.

As of the time of this writing, this feature is only available when importing AAF files.

Simple AAF Import

This section covers the Import AAF, EDL, XML dialog in much more detail. One procedure lets you accomplish any of the following workflows:

- Importing an AAF file and automatically conforming to and importing the media it’s linked to.
- Importing an AAF file and manually choosing another set of media, presumably in a different format or resolution, with identical metadata, to conform to instead.
- Importing an AAF file that’s linked to offline media derived from a camera original format, and automatically conforming it to and importing the camera original media.

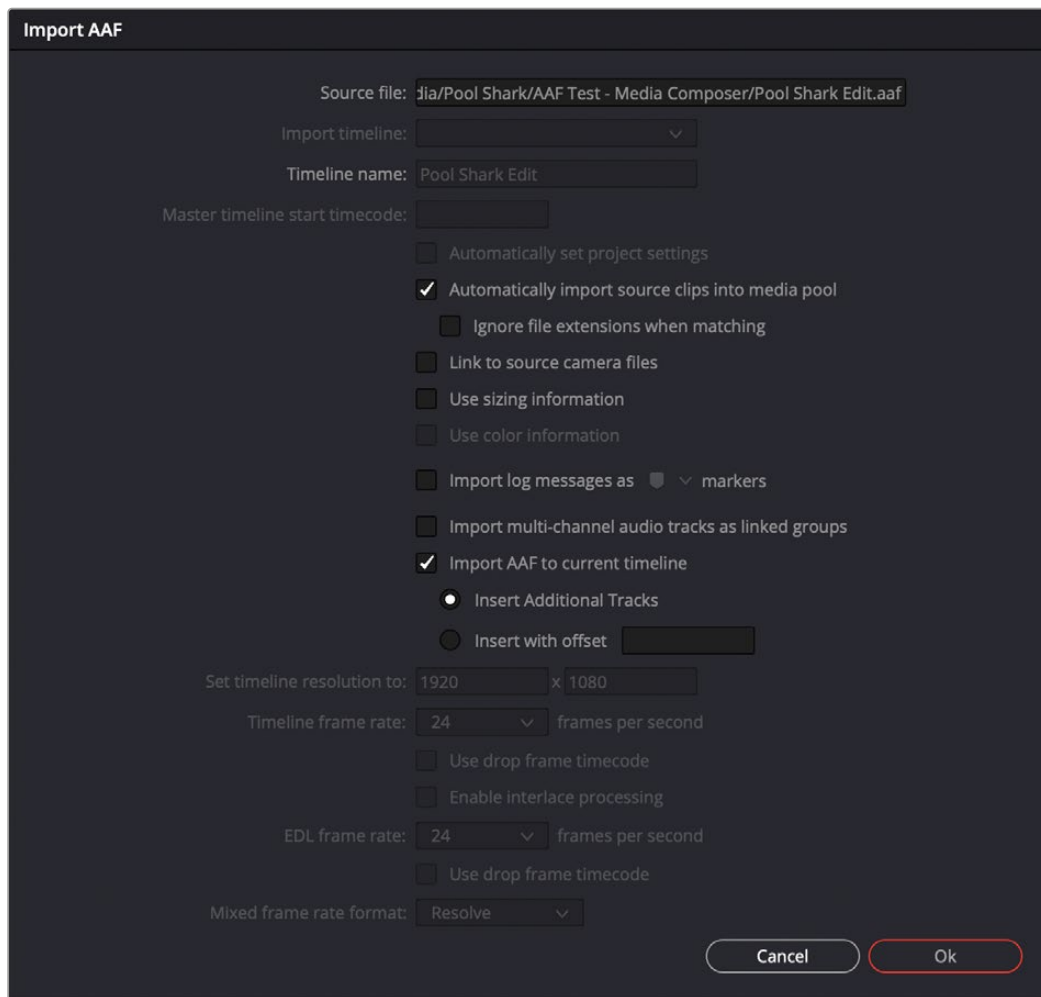
You can select multiple XML, AAF, FCP XML, or EDL timelines (or any combination thereof) at the same time using the Timeline Import dialog. The selected timelines will import sequentially, pausing after each time the OK button is pressed, allowing you to adjust separate Import Settings for each timeline.

Each of these workflows is possible by choosing the correct combination of options, each of which is described in the following procedure.

To load an AAF file and automatically link to its referenced media:

- 1 Do one of the following:
 - From any page, choose File > Import Timeline (Shift-Command-I).
 - Open the Edit page, right-click anywhere in the Media Pool, and choose Timelines > Import > AAF/EDL/XML/DRT/ADL/OTIO.

- 2 Using the file dialog that appears, find the project file you want to import, and click the file to open it. The Load AAF window appears, depending on your selection.



Options when importing an AAF file

- 3 Choose the options that are applicable to your particular project. By default, these options are based on metadata within the file you selected.
- **Source file:** The file you selected in the previous step.
 - **Import timeline:** If there are multiple sequences within the selected AAF source file, this pop-up menu lets you choose which sequence to import as a DaVinci Resolve timeline.
 - **Timeline name:** The name of the Timeline you're about to create. This defaults to the name of the sequence that was exported, but you can change it if you like.
 - **Master timeline start timecode:** The timecode at which the imported timeline will start. This automatically matches the start timecode of the selected Import Timeline.
 - **Automatically set project settings:** Leave this option on to automatically change the frame size and frame rate settings in the Project tab of the Config page with those in this window. You can import timelines with frame rates that are different from the Project frame rate.
 - **Automatically import source clips into media pool:** Leave this checkbox on to automatically import the media referenced by the AAF project file you selected into the Media Pool based on the embedded file paths. If the media files are not automatically found at these locations, you will be prompted to manually select a directory where the clips are located.

Ignore file extensions when matching: Turn this checkbox on if you want to manually choose a different directory of media to link to; for example, if the AAF you're importing links to ProRes Proxy media, and you want to relink to another directory of corresponding ProRes 4444 or camera raw media.

- **Use sizing information:** Lets you import position, scale, and rotation transforms from the originating NLE via the imported AAF project file. These transforms are stored in each clip's settings in the Edit page Inspector.
- **Import log messages as COLOR markers:** Turn on this checkbox and choose a color from the accompanying drop-down menu for markers that will be placed in the Timeline with note text describing import errors that you might want to troubleshoot later.
- **Import multi-channel audio tracks as linked groups:** Turn on this checkbox if you want to import multi-channel audio, such as stereo, 5.1, and 7.1 audio into individual mono timeline tracks that are linked together in the Fairlight page.

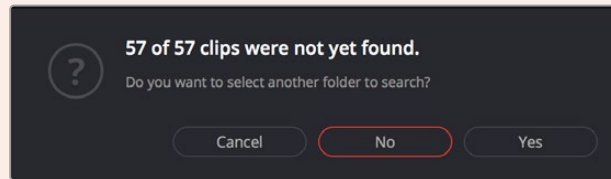
For more information about Linked Groups, see *Chapter 171, "Setting Up Tracks, Busses, and Patching."* If this checkbox is turned off, multi-channel audio will be imported into multi-channel audio tracks in the Timeline.

- **Import AAF to current timeline:** Imports the AAF to the currently loaded Timeline, instead of creating a new timeline in the Media Pool.

Insert Additional Tracks: Automatically assigns new tracks to the Timeline, so the AAF referenced media does not overwrite current clips on the existing timeline.

Insert with offset: Overwrites the AAF referenced media on the Timeline and offsets it by the amount set in timecode format.

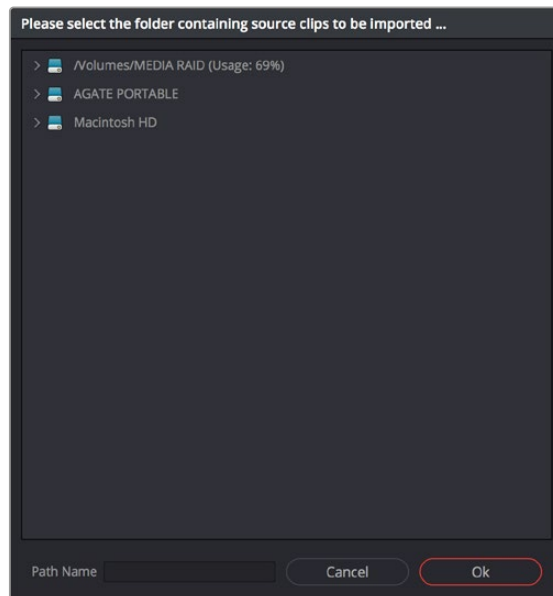
- **Set timeline resolution to:** Two fields let you specify the width and height of the frame size you want to work at in DaVinci Resolve. The default is whatever resolution is specified in the AAF file being imported.
 - **Timeline frame rate:** By default, this is derived from the frame rate of the AAF file being imported. If you're importing an AAF file into a project that already has media in the Media Pool, the Timeline frame rate is locked and cannot be changed.
 - **Use drop frame timecode:** By default, this is derived from the AAF file being imported.
 - **EDL frame rate:** By default, this is derived from the frame rate of the selected file.
 - **Use drop frame timecode:** By default, this is derived from the frame rate of the selected file.
 - **Mixed frame rate format:** This drop-down menu lets you choose the method used to conform mixed frame rates for rendering and playback. You can choose the "Final Cut Pro 7" or "Final Cut Pro X" methods of conform, while for projects imported from Media Composer, Premiere Pro, Smoke, or other NLEs, you should leave this set to "DaVinci Resolve." This drop-down menu also appears in the Load AAF dialogs when you import a project.
- 4 After choosing all necessary settings, click OK.
 - 5 Assuming you left "Automatically import source clips into media pool," turned on, if the media linked to by the AAF file is not in the expected disk location, or if you turned on the "Ignore file extensions when matching" checkbox, then another dialog appears prompting you to choose the folder within which the media for this project is stored. Do one of the following:
 - **If you want to try to relink to media in another disk location:** Click Yes, and then navigate to the folder containing your media (all subfolders will be automatically traversed as well), select it, and click OK.
 - **If you want to just import the Timeline with all offline clips:** Click No.



A prompt appears if all the media was not found

IMPORTANT: It's always possible to choose the top level of any volume to automatically find all media in any directories located within, but if the volume is large and full of many files, scanning every folder and document of the volume may be an extremely time-intensive process.

- 6 If you clicked Yes to selecting another folder, then use the folder selection dialog to navigate to another folder, and click Ok. You can cycle through this process as many times as you need to until you've found all the media that timeline is linked to.



Selecting the source folder for your AAF imported clips

The AAF file is imported. A new timeline and the referenced media files appear in the Media Pool, and the Timeline is opened so you can see its contents. Simple nested clips should also come through. Clips that could not be linked to a corresponding file on disk appear red in both the Media Pool and Timeline to indicate that they're offline and unlinked.

TIP: You can open the Edit Index and choose Filter Offline Clips from the option menu to see a list of all offline clips in the current Timeline.

Supported AAF Timeline Features

The following additional AAF timeline information will automatically be imported to DaVinci Resolve:

- **Timeline Markers:** Any timeline markers within the AAF will be imported. Timeline markers can also be exported from DaVinci Resolve to AAF for round-trip workflows.
- **Nested Clips:** DaVinci Resolve will import AAF files with simple nested clips.
- **Boris Continuum FX:** Boris Continuum FX effects and settings will be imported along with a timeline via AAF export. You'll need to have the same Continuum suite of effects installed on both machines (OFX version for DaVinci Resolve, AVX for Avid). When importing an AAF, Boris Continuum effects that were used in the original NLE will appear on each affected clip in the resulting DaVinci Resolve timeline, with all previously applied parameters available in the Inspector. The Sapphire and Mocha suites are not available for AAF import at this time.

Performing an AAF Avid Round Trip

This section outlines a comprehensive workflow for creating projects in Media Composer that will be compatible with DaVinci Resolve, moving projects from Media Composer to DaVinci Resolve, then grading, rendering, and sending the final graded project back to Media Composer. The following steps include procedures covering the following tasks:

- Ingesting all media as high quality MXF-wrapped DNxHD, then round tripping from Media Composer to DaVinci Resolve.
- Importing and editing Resolve-compatible AMA-linked media formats, then round tripping from Media Composer to DaVinci Resolve.
- Transcoding AMA-linked media files into offline-quality DNxHD clips for editing, then exporting an AAF file and reconforming it in DaVinci Resolve to high quality camera original media as part of the round trip.

Because there are so many variations in the way that Media Composer can ingest media and output AAF projects, you should familiarize yourself with the following procedures before continuing with your own project.

Step 1 – Create a Project in Media Composer

- 1 When creating a project in Media Composer, take note of the image format details, as these should be matched in DaVinci Resolve. In particular, set the image format (e.g., 1080p/24) and raster dimensions (e.g., 1920x1080) to match your desired mastering format. Also, color space should be set to RGB 709 if you're planning to send ingested/transcoded media from Media Composer to DaVinci Resolve for grading.

NOTE: This information can also be found in the Avid Project Format tab.

- 2 Open your project, and ingest all necessary media into a new bin using one or both of the following methods:
 - **Transcode media for editing:** The simplest workflow for AAF import and round-trip workflows is to ingest transcoded, native MXF-wrapped DNxHD media using the Import command.
 - **Import AMA-linked clips:** You can also import AMA-linked clips, so long as all AMA-linked files are in a format that's compatible with DaVinci Resolve. Keep in mind that not all AMA-compatible formats can be consolidated in Media Composer. In this case, import AMA-linked media into a new bin using the Link to AMA File(s) command, and edit as usual.

Once you've ingested all necessary media, you can edit your project as you would any other, keeping in mind which effects are compatible with DaVinci Resolve. For more information on effects in Media Composer to DaVinci Resolve round trips, see *Chapter 55, "Preparing Timelines for Import and Comparison."*

Step 2 – Exporting an AAF for DaVinci Resolve

When you're finished editing, you need to export an AAF that will conform the .mxf media you used in Media Composer into a DaVinci Resolve timeline. Two export configuration options are available, depending on whether DaVinci Resolve and Media Composer are on the same system.

- 1 Select the sequence you want to export, and choose File > Output > Export to File.
- 2 In the Export As dialog, type a name for the AAF file you'll be exporting.
- 3 Choose a location to save the AAF. You can save it anywhere you like, but if you're moving the project to another workstation, you may want to save it to a specific folder on a removable hard drive where you store your AAF and XML files. The location you choose can also be used as the location of the media that's exported to accompany the AAF.
- 4 Click the Options button to open a more detailed window of export settings.
- 5 Turn on the AAF Edit Protocol checkbox. This option forces Media Composer to export a simplified AAF file that's more compatible with the project exchange workflows of different applications.
- 6 Choose the appropriate option from the Export Method pop-up menu to configure how the AAF and its accompanying media will be exported. The option you choose depends on the following:

If Media Composer and DaVinci Resolve are on the same system: Choose "Link to (Don't Export) Media" to export an AAF file that links to the existing media in its current location. Click the Audio Details tab and choose "Link to (Don't Export) Media" from the Export Method pop-up menu.

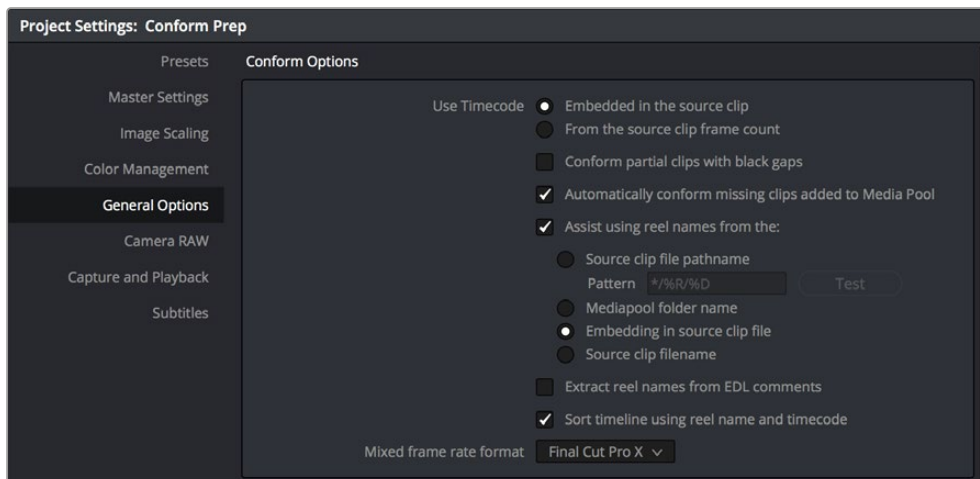
If Media Composer and DaVinci Resolve are on different systems: Choose one of the two following export methods:

- **Copy All Media:** For each source clip used, the entire corresponding media file is copied. This can be useful when you want to preserve the original relationship of each clip to the source media file it came from. However, be aware that you'll potentially be exporting a lot of media when you use this option.
 - **Consolidate Media:** This is a more efficient media management workflow for finished projects, since unused media will not be copied. You can specify additional handles to add to the beginning and end of each exported media file, in frames, in the Handle Length field. Should any media file and its handles overlap another media file and its handles, both will be combined into a single exported media file.
- 7 (Optional) If you're using a combination of media in your project that includes formats that aren't compatible with DaVinci Resolve, you can optionally turn on the "Transcode Video To" checkbox and choose a media format from the pop-up menu to the right. This option automatically transcodes all media in your sequence that doesn't match the format specified in the pop-up to match that format.
 - 8 If you're copying or consolidating media to another drive, choose "Folder" from the Media Destinations Video/Data pop-up menu. Turn on the "Use Same Folder As AAF File" checkbox to save the exported media to the same folder you selected in step 3. If you leave this checkbox turned off, you can click Select Folder to choose another location.
 - 9 Click Save, and when you return to the Export As dialog, click Save again.

Once export is complete, you'll see a duplicate sequence and duplicate media populating your Media Composer bin, with the suffix ".Exported" appended to the sequence, and ".new" appended to each media clip. In the file system, the resulting folder contains an AAF file, and an Avid MediaFiles folder that contains the exported media.

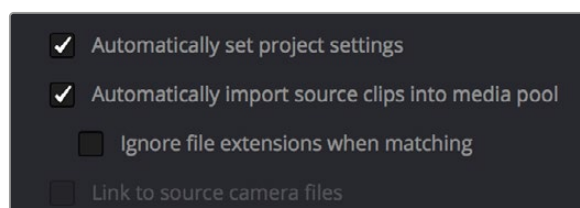
Step 3 – Conforming Your AAF in DaVinci Resolve

- 1 Open DaVinci Resolve and create a new project.
- 2 Before you do anything else, you need to set DaVinci Resolve to properly read the timecode and reel number information from the AAF files that Media Composer creates. Click the gear button at the lower right-hand side of the DaVinci Resolve window to open the Project Settings window, click General Options to reveal the Conform Options, and do the following:
 - Make sure that "Use Timecode" is set to "Embedded in the source clip."
 - Turn the "Assist using reel names from the" checkbox on, and choose "Embedding in source clip file."



Conform assistance with reel names embedded in the source clip

- 3 Click Save.
- 4 Do one of the following:
 - From any page, choose File > Import AAF, EDL, XML (Shift-Command-I).
 - Open the Edit page, right-click anywhere in the Media Pool, and choose Timelines > Import > AAF/EDL/XML.
- 5 When the File Selection window opens, select the AAF file you exported from Media Composer, and click Open.
- 6 When the Load AAF dialog appears, the settings you choose determine which media files the AAF will be conformed to:



Load AAF window conform options

To conform to the transcoded or AMA-linked media files you edited: Leave the “Automatically import source clips into media pool” checkbox turned on.

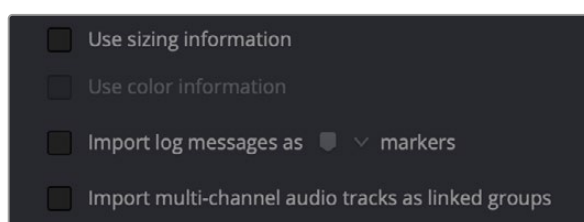
To conform to a different set of camera original media files: Turn on both the “Automatically import source clips into media pool” and “Link to source camera files” checkboxes, which references the Source Name metadata that Media Composer/Symphony embeds in exported AAF files to track the correspondence in file naming between transcoded and camera original media.

To conform to a directory of media of your choosing: Turn on both the “Automatically import source clips into media pool” and “Ignore file extensions when matching” checkboxes.

To conform to media that’s already in the Media Pool: Turn off the “Automatically import source clips into media pool” checkbox. There must be clips in the Media Pool for this to work.

7 Additionally, make sure that the “Automatically set project settings” checkbox is on.

8 There are three other options that are relevant to AAF import:



Load AAF window conform options

Use Sizing Information: (Optional) Use this checkbox if you want to import position, scale, and rotate transform data from the originating Media Composer project into DaVinci Resolve.

Import log messages as COLOR markers: Turn on this checkbox and choose a color from the accompanying drop-down menu for markers that will be placed in the Timeline with note text describing import errors that you might want to troubleshoot later.

Import multi-channel audio tracks as linked groups: Turn on this checkbox if you want to import multi-channel audio, such as stereo, 5.1, and 7.1 audio into individual mono timeline tracks that are linked together in the Fairlight page.

For more information about Linked Groups, see *Chapter 171, “Setting Up Tracks, Busses, and Patching.”* If this checkbox is turned off, multi-channel audio will be imported into multi-channel audio tracks in the Timeline.

9 Click OK.

As long as the media remains where it was when you exported it from Media Composer, the timeline and all its media should now import. However, if the location of the media files you’re conforming to has changed, then you may need to identify the location of the media via an additional dialog. For example, if you’ve copied the media from the portable hard drive it was originally conformed to, to a faster storage volume, then a file dialog appears, requesting that you choose the folder containing the media used by your project. If prompted, do so and click OK.

Once import is complete, the Media Pool fills with the source media used by the imported project, and the edit appears as the current Timeline in the Edit page.

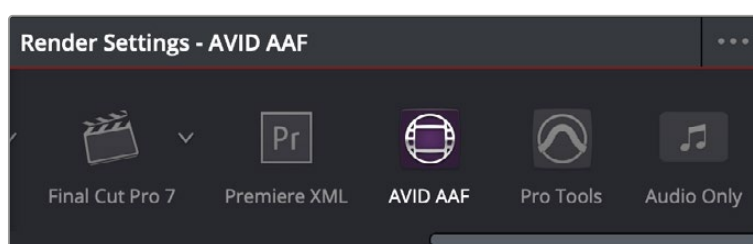
Step 4 – Continue Editing, Grading, and Finishing the Project

Edit the Timeline in the Edit page and grade each clip in the Color page as you would any other. However, you should be aware that if you use the tools found in the Edit page to make any editorial changes to the timeline you've imported, your export options will change later on:

- **If you don't make editing changes:** Then you have the option to have DaVinci Resolve use the Avid AAF file that you originally imported to generate an updated one. This preserves audio and all other unsupported effects from the original AAF file, so that they reappear when you export a new AAF back to Media Composer. If you use this option, you need to make sure the original AAF file you import remains in the same location.
- **If you do make editing changes:** Then you need to use the "Generate New AAF" command to export an AAF of the re-edited Timeline from DaVinci Resolve back to Media Composer. This newly generated AAF file will not include any effects that are not supported by DaVinci Resolve.

Step 5 – Render Graded Media and Export a New AAF

- 1 When you're ready to send a graded project back to Media Composer, select the Timeline you graded and open the Deliver page.
- 2 Choose "Avid AAF" from the Presets at the top of the Render Settings to load its settings.



Selecting the Avid AAF setup for round-trip

- 3 In the Format section, choose the MXF codec you want to render to.
- 4 In the File section, choose the appropriate file destination path for the rendered media. The location you choose depends on whether Media Composer and DaVinci Resolve are on the same computer or not.

If Media Composer and DaVinci Resolve are on the same computer: Create a new folder within your Avid MediaFiles folder (Avid MediaFiles/MXF/) named with a number. Make sure you choose a previously unused number.

If DaVinci Resolve is on a different computer using different storage: Select any directory on the portable hard drive you'll be using to bring the media back to the Media Composer workstation from which it came.

- 5 If you require handles for your rendered output, you can add handles in the Advanced Settings of the Video tab. When making any changes to the File render settings, make sure to leave the "Render Clip with Unique Filename" checkbox turned on to ensure that each clip rendered has a different file name as multiple clips in the edited sequence may originate from the same source clip.
- 6 In the Timeline, click Select Entire Timeline to select the entire Timeline for delivery, and then click Add to Render Queue at the bottom of the Render Settings to add the job you've set up to the Render Queue.
- 7 Click Start Render at the bottom of the Render Queue to initiate rendering.

The project renders, and an AAF is automatically exported to the same directory as the media you've rendered.

Step 6 – Copy the Graded Media to Avid MediaFiles

- 1 For workflows where DaVinci Resolve and Media Composer are on separate workstations, locate the media directory containing the media files that were rendered out of DaVinci Resolve on the portable hard drive being used to transport the project back to your Avid workstation, and copy it into the Avid MediaFiles/MXF/ directory.
- 2 Rename the directory to be a number. Make sure you choose an unused number.

Step 7 – Import the Graded AAF

- 1 Reopen the original project in Media Composer. If the media in the new directory of the Avid MediaFiles folder is in a compatible format, it will automatically be added to the internal database of media.
- 2 Create a new bin to contain the graded sequence you're about to import.
- 3 Open the new bin, then choose File > Input > Import Media, select the graded AAF file that you exported from DaVinci Resolve, and click Open.
- 4 As long as the media is available in the Avid MediaFiles directory, the new bin you've created should automatically fill up with the clips that were rendered out of DaVinci Resolve, and a new sequence should appear.
- 5 Double click the sequence you've imported to open it into the Record monitor and Timeline, fully conformed with the color corrected clips from DaVinci Resolve. This sequence is now ready for finishing in Media Composer.

Relinking Transcoded Media to AMA Media

This next workflow is useful when you've been editing transcoded, offline versions of processor- or bandwidth-intensive media, but you want to send the original high-quality source media (such as ALEXA or RED raw files) to DaVinci Resolve for grading. In certain situations, it may be better to reconform your sequence to the original AMA-linked media files in Media Composer before you round trip from Media Composer to DaVinci Resolve.

Step 1 – Relink Your Transcoded Media to AMA-Linked Source

- 1 Edit a sequence using media that you've transcoded within Media Composer.
- 2 When you're finished, open the bin that contains your project's camera original media, and select the AMA-linked clips that correspond to the transcoded clips you've been editing.
- 3 Right-click the edited sequence in its bin, and choose Relink from the contextual menu.
- 4 When the Relink dialog appears, turn on "Select items in ALL open bins." Select "Tape Name or Source File Name" under the Source Name settings, and leave the "Create new sequence" checkbox turned on.

A new sequence is created that is now linked to the AMA-linked camera originals.

Step 2 – Export an AAF File

- 1 Select the new sequence that was created, and choose File > Output > Export to File.
- 2 Type a new name, choose a location for the file, and click Options.
- 3 Choose AAF from the Export As pop-up menu, and choose "Link to (Don't Export) Media" from the Export Method pop-up menu.
- 4 Click Audio Details, and choose "Link to (Don't Export) Media" from the Export Method pop-up menu.
- 5 Click Save to exit the Export Settings dialog, and then click Save again to export the file.

Step 3 – Import the AAF, Grade, Render, and Export

- 1 Open DaVinci Resolve, and import the AAF file you exported into the Edit page. You'll need to manually select the media in a second dialog.
- 2 Grade the project as you would any other.
- 3 When you're done grading, use the AAF Round Trip option in the Deliver page to render the graded media into a new (numbered) directory in the Avid MediaFiles directory.
- 4 Open the Edit page, select the original AAF timeline you imported, right-click it, and choose Export AAF/XML. Pick a location for the file and click Save.

Step 4 – Reimport the AAF into Media Composer/Symphony

Open Media Composer, and import the AAF you exported from DaVinci Resolve. Your graded sequence is now ready for finishing.

Audio AAF Import from Pro Tools

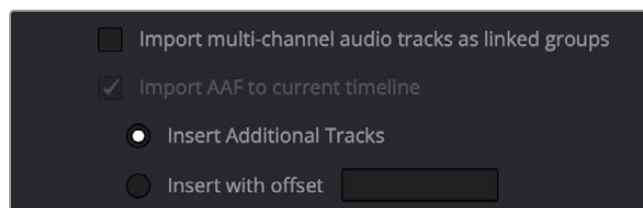
Importing audio AAF timelines from Pro Tools (or any DAW software capable of exporting AAF) works similarly to the workflow for importing a video AAF from Media Composer that's detailed at the beginning of this chapter. However, there are two methods you can use.

Import AAF, EDL, XML

Using the File > Import Timeline > Import AAF, EDL, XML command (Command-Shift-I), you can select a Pro Tools AAF. You're presented with all the same import options as a Media Composer AAF, but what you end up with is an audio-only timeline, to which you can add a reference video if you need to.

Import AAF to Current Timeline

Using the File > Import Timeline > Import AAF to Current Timeline command lets you import an audio AAF to the currently open timeline. When you use this command, the import dialog presents similar import options, however, there are two additional options to choose from.



Additional options available when you use the "Import AAF to current timeline" command

The "Import AAF to current timeline" checkbox is on, and presents two options:

- **Insert Additional Tracks:** Lets you import the audio tracks starting at the beginning of the current timeline, placing them underneath the lowest track with existing audio in the Timeline.
- **Insert with offset:** Lets you import the audio tracks with a specified offset from the beginning of the Timeline.